



Market Briefs **Pro**

Read less news

Happy Saturday, Pro Briefers!

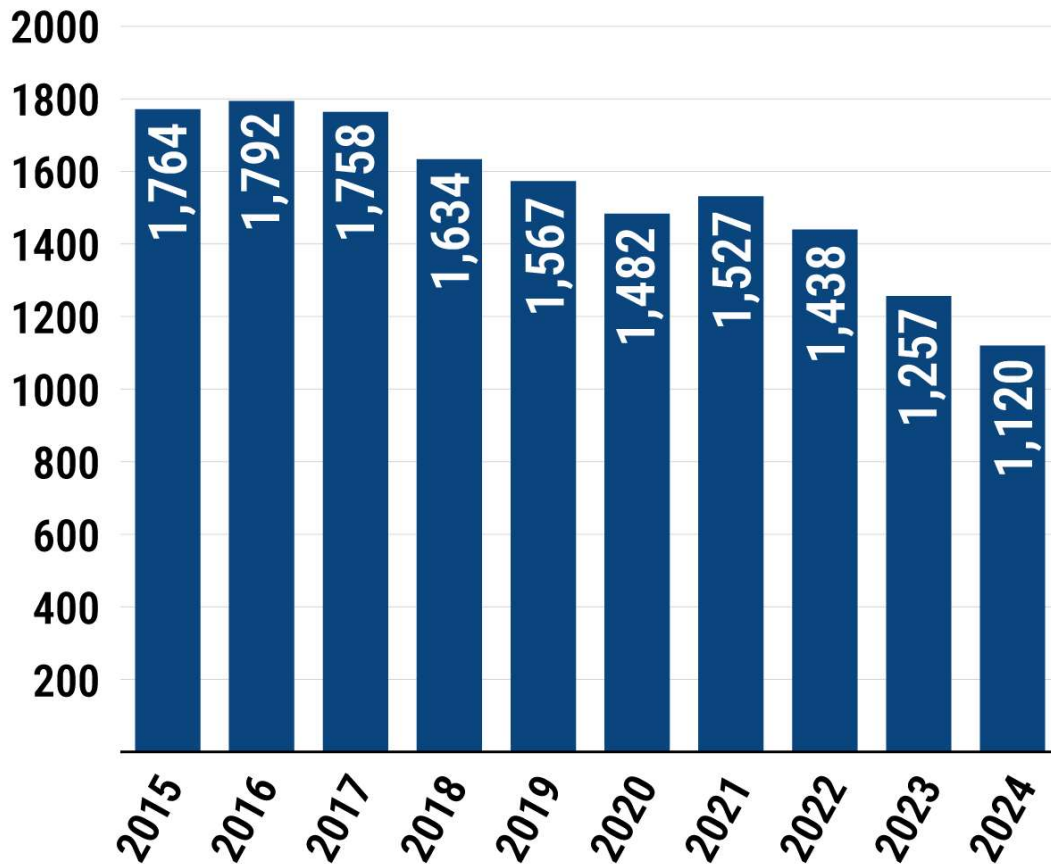
This week we've identified an Innovation Shift: Declining wild fish populations with growing demand for seafood has led to the rise of aquaculture and opportunities in aqua nutrition, tech, and production.

Let's explore how investors may be able to *reel* in this opportunity.

There *aren't* plenty of fish in the sea - that's according to the National Fisheries Institute, which has been tracking fish populations for more than a decade.

According to its data, the worldwide supply of cod reached a decade low in 2024.

Cod Supply Is Down More Than 33% In Last 10 Years And The Decline Has Accelerated In Last 3 Years



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Data [via](#) National Fisheries Institute

- Other seafood like shrimp and salmon have also seen major decreases in population.

What's going on? The problem is two-fold:

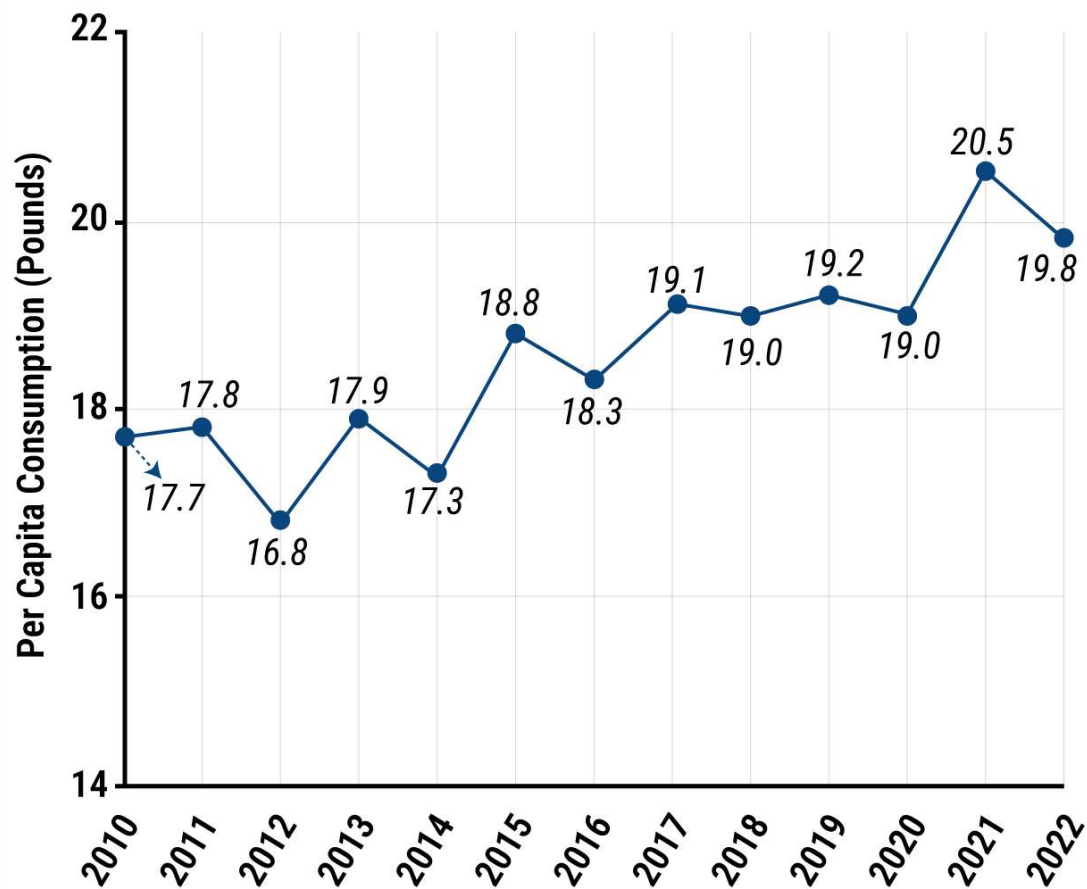
First, Americans (and the world) are eating more seafood - in 2021 the typical American consumed almost 21 pounds of seafood, an all-time record.

- That's up from just under 18 pounds in 2010.

Our Market Analysts spoke to experts at the Aquaculture Stewardship Council (ASC) in an exclusive interview - their team reaffirmed that demand for fish is growing:

"As the world population grows, so too does the demand for fish. Fish is a high protein, low fat, healthy and nutritionally rich food. But traditional methods of wild capture fishing can't possibly meet the demand."

U.S. Per Capita Seafood Consumption Slips After Strong 2021



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Data via NOAA

The second problem is overfishing, which has increased as demand for seafood has gone up.

So businesses are now taking the sea out of seafood with a new kind of innovation: Aquaculture.

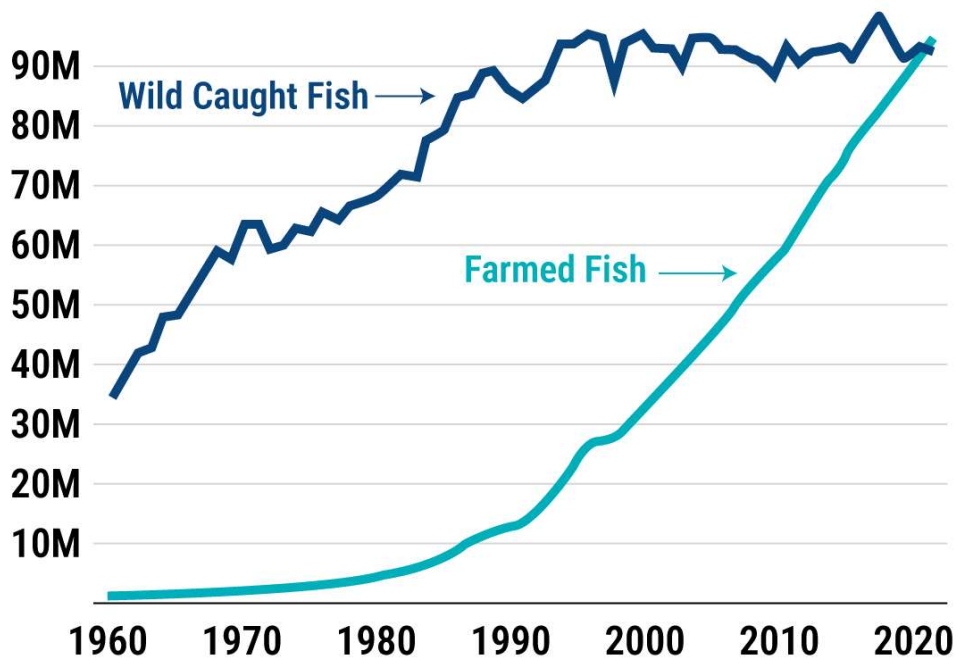
"Aquaculture is the fastest growing food production system in the world and it has the capacity to meet global demand while reducing the pressure on wild capture fisheries." - Aquaculture Stewardship Council.

Aquaculture breeds fish in farms, rather than catching fish in the ocean.

In fact, for the first time in 2022, the world ate more fish from farms than from the ocean, a trend that continues to grow in 2025.

The World Now Eats More Fish From Farms Than From The Ocean

After Decades Of Rapid Growth, Fish Farming Finally Overtook Commercial Fishing In 2022.



Both Farmed Fish And Wild-Caught Fish Are Measured In Millions Of Metric Tons.

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Data [via](#) FAO

Aquaculture has now created several long-term spending shifts that we believe investors should keep an eye on.

We want your feedback: Tell us what you think about this edition of Market Briefs Pro [by clicking here](#).

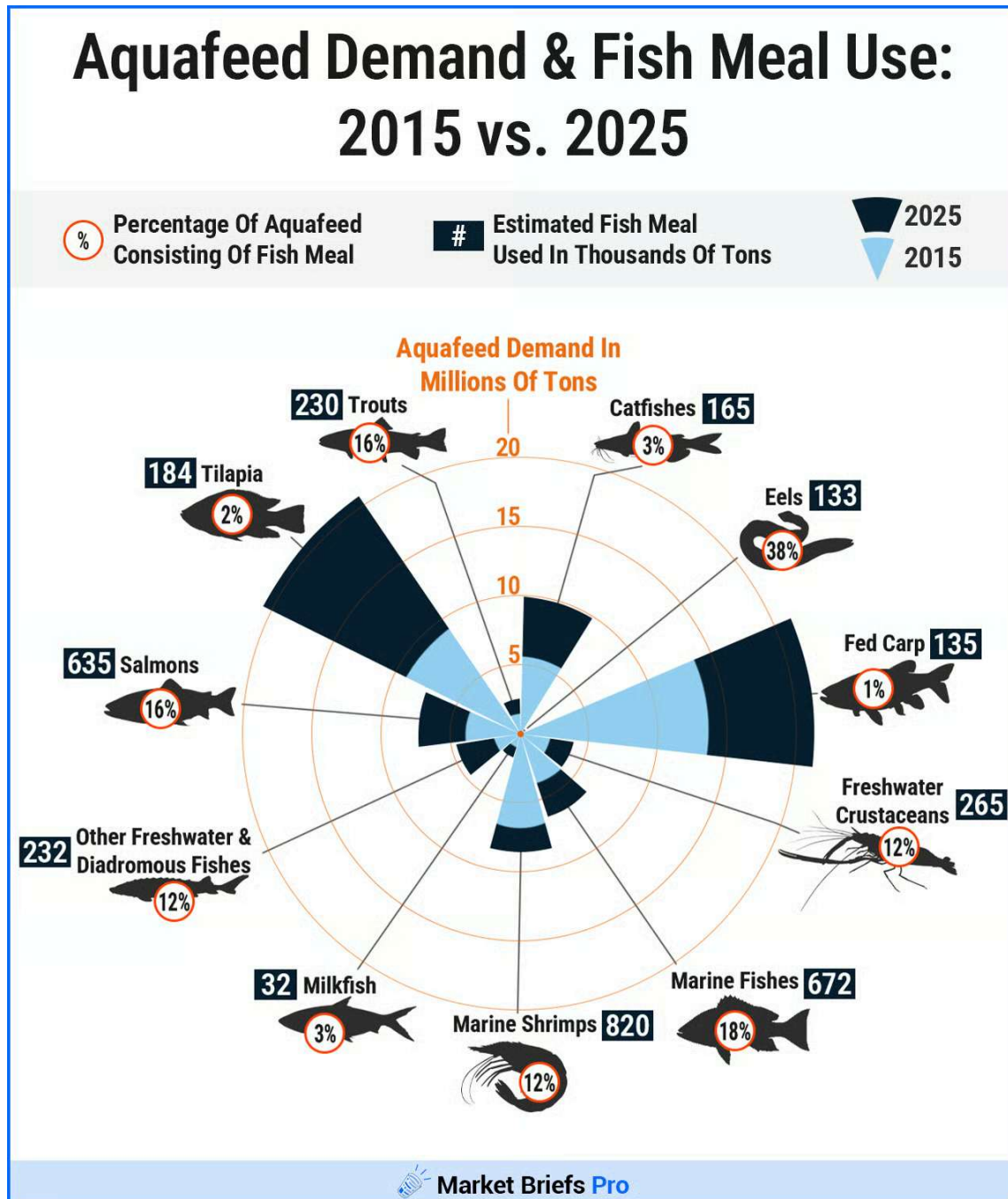
NUTRITION

Raising Healthy Fish

Aquaculture facilities are used to grow and feed fish farms.

Naturally, more farmed fish means more fish food needs to be produced.

Farmed fish populations in aquaculture have special diets - this helps keep them healthier and grow larger than fish caught in the wild.



Data via One Earth

Farmed fish are given special vitamins that make their immune system stronger to certain diseases while in captivity.

The point? Healthier and larger fish means more seafood meat can be sold.

Ray Dhirani, ASC Head of Capital Markets Outreach also believes that fish food specifically is one of the largest investment opportunities for investors.

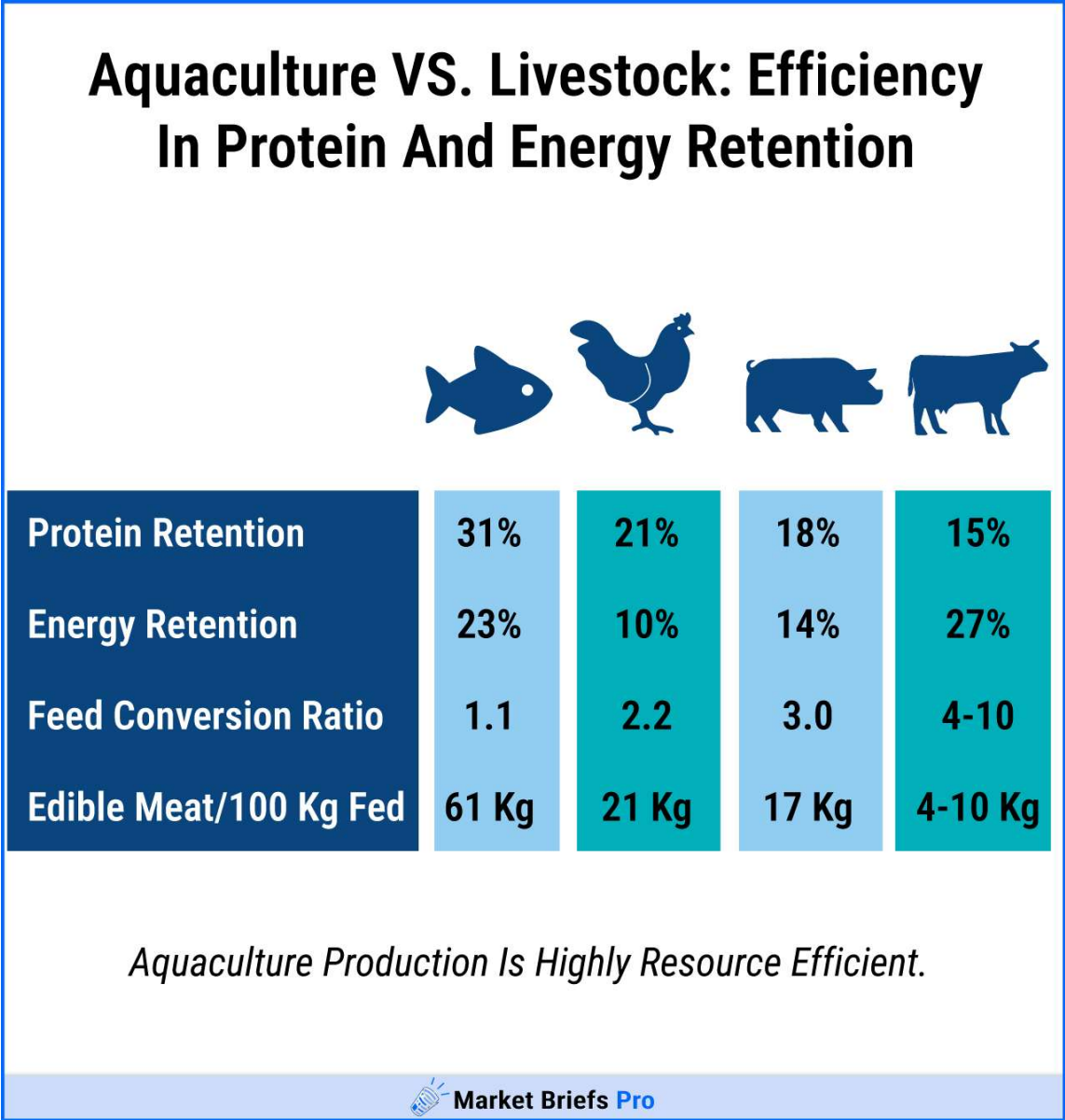
"New technologies as well as sustainable feed ingredients, are looking to improve yield through innovative production methods, and most recently

investors are also looking at investments to improve fish welfare, reduce disease, and improve medical treatment."

Businesses that produce these foods and supplements are now benefiting from this shift.

Phibro Animal Health Corporation (PAHC), a publicly traded stock, provides supplements for farmed fish.

These supplements help prevent diseases common among various species of fish.



Data [via](#) Global Aquaculture Alliance

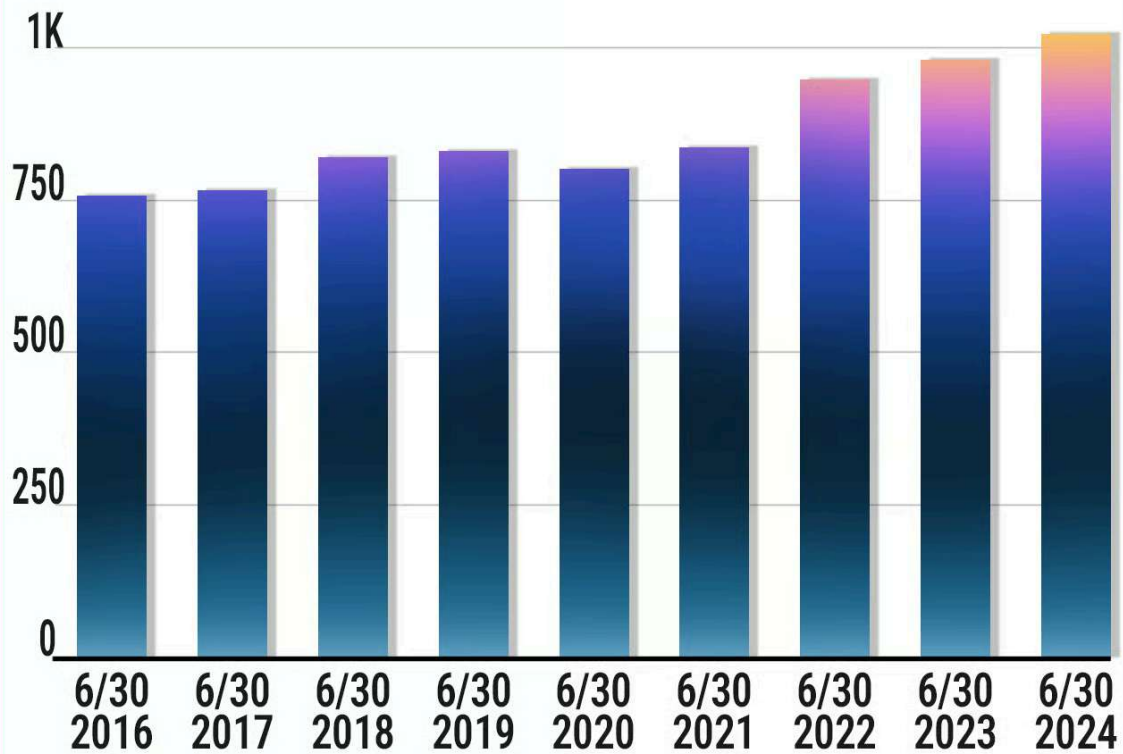
And its solutions are natural.

- This supplement helps fish retain more of their food - so they can grow larger - and helps to prevent diseases.

This supplement has been proven to increase viability and success of fish farms.

Phibro Animal Health Corporation (PAHC) Revenues

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

How much success? Studies have shown that Phibro's supplement has reduced fish deaths by 10-20%.

In 2024, Phibro earned \$1 billion in annual revenue, the most it has seen in over a decade.

Phibro Animal Health Corporation (PAHC)

5 Year Price →

21.81
(22.05%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Last year, Phibro even became the first company to receive FDA approval for a supplement that reduces death rates among freshwater aquaculture fish.

Supplements keep the animals healthy, but special food ensures the fish are safe for us to consume later.

Balchem Corporation (BCPC) creates special fish food for aquaculture farms - specifically, its choline food reduces the amount of food fish need in captivity by 10%.

In English? Fewer feedings and more efficient aquaculture operations = more fish that can be produced, and sold.

Balchem Corporation (BCPC)

5 Year Price →

163.40
(+73.37%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

In addition, Balchem consistently meets federal regulations for purity standards in its fish food, reducing its exposure to damaging chemicals and pesticides by 100% in some cases.

That means fewer harmful chemicals are passed on to people when they eat the fish.

Its fish food is also able to be stored longer than other brands due to its high purity rating, which has led to a 5% reduction of waste at aquaculture farms.

Balchem Corporation (BCPC)



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Data [via](#) company reports

According to its latest 10k, the company earned a record high revenue of \$953 million in 2024, up from \$799 million in 2021.

The opportunities in fish nutrition may keep swimming for investors, along with broader opportunities like the iShares MSCI Agriculture Producers ETF (VEGI), which also has a dividend yield of 2.97%.

iShares MSCI Agriculture Producers ETF (VEGI)

5 Year Price →

37.38
(+95%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

EQUIPMENT

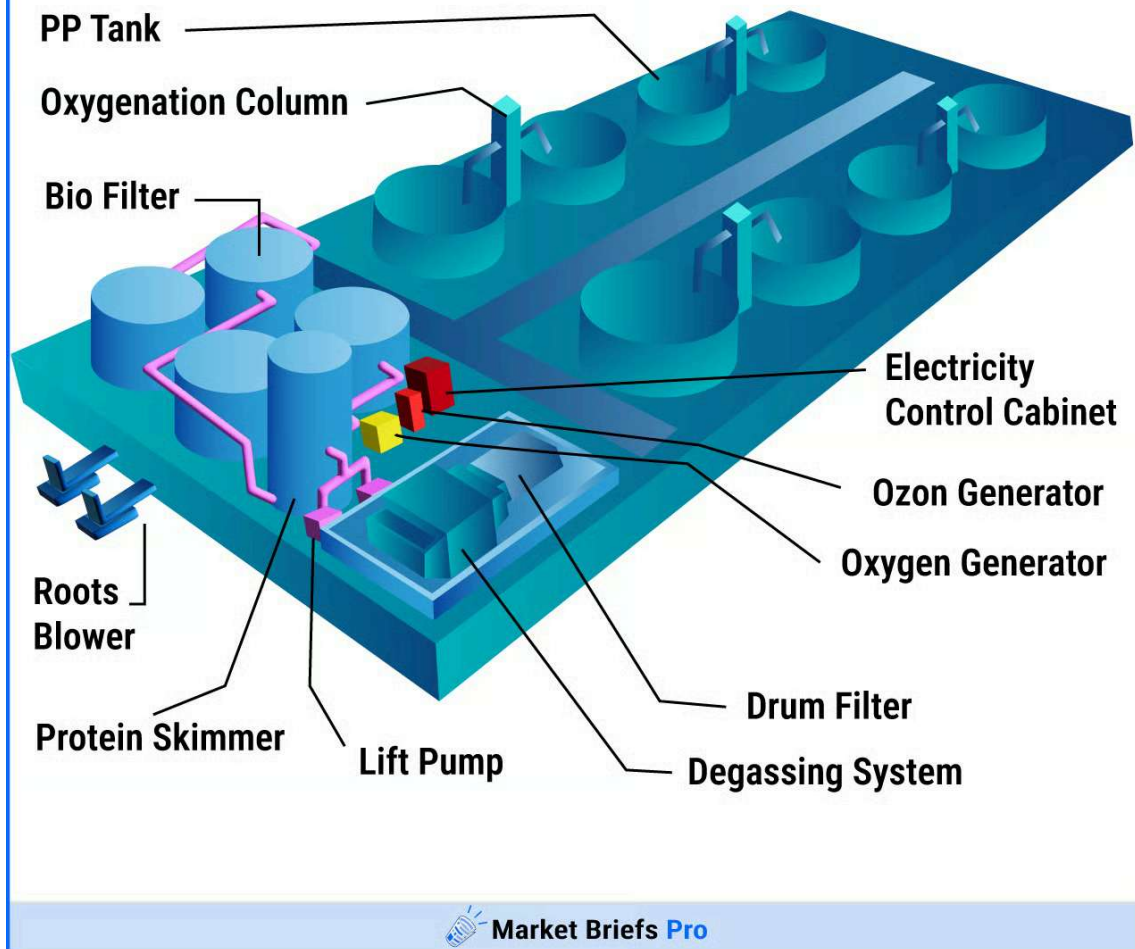
Aqua Tools

Aquaculture involves spawning and raising fish in large tanks.

Because of this, it takes special equipment to make sure the conditions that the fish are held in are humane, safe, and conducive for growth.

Aquaculture facilities ensure safety in two ways: Water filtration and water treatment.

Aquaculture System For Tilapia Production



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Data via Suqian Jinshihui

Fact: Water in aquaculture tanks is replaced every two weeks on average.

- Replacing the water enables facilities to maintain the right pH balance, as well as make sure no toxic materials poison the fish.

One of the major players here in aquaculture water filtration is Pentair plc (PNR).

The company specializes in water filters for aquaculture tanks that are essential for the filtration process.

Why? Its filters can recirculate 99% of existing water - the highest in the industry - which means removing nearly all toxic materials without needing new water.

Pentair plc (PNR)

5 Year Price →

88.27
(+271.19%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

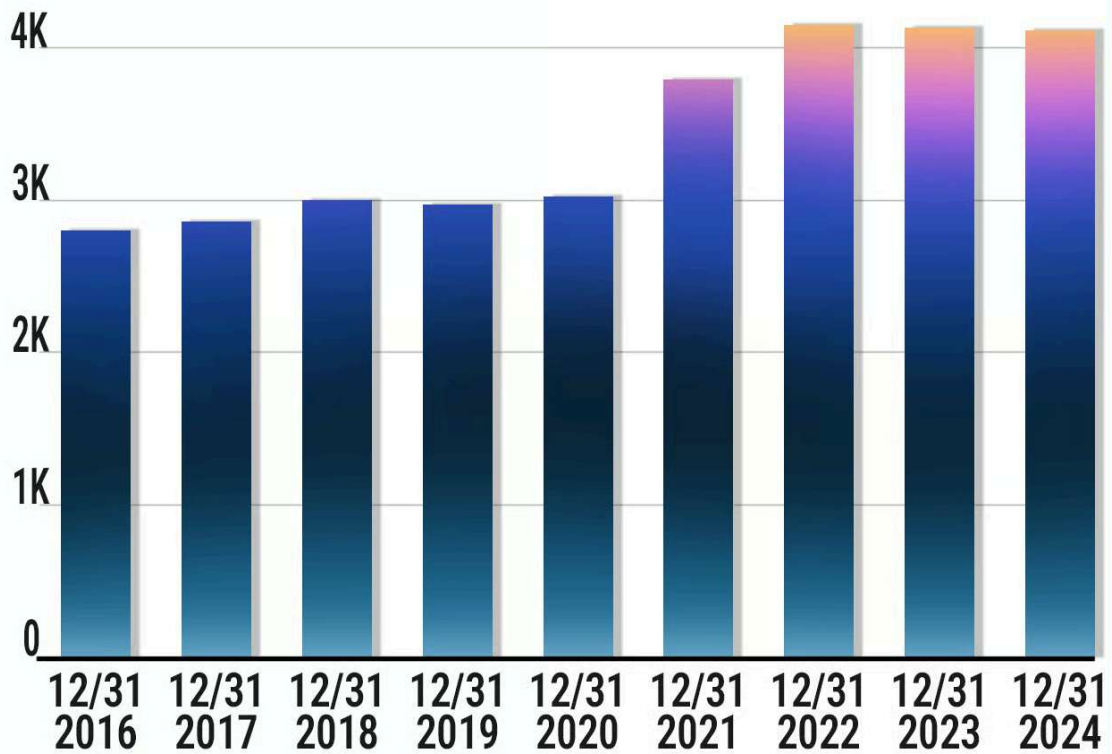
- Aquaculture facilities that use Pentair's filters have seen around a 90% reduction in water usage.

Better water = healthier fish. By maintaining optimal water conditions, aquaculture facilities have reduced fish death rates by 20%, all with the help of Pentair's filters.

Pentair's revenue has jumped as demand for its products has grown - it reported just over \$4 billion in revenue in 2024, an increase from \$3.7 billion in 2021.

Pentair Plc (PNR)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data [via](#) company reports

Filters help keep the water safe, but pumps move the water in and out of aquaculture facilities, another necessary operation.

Xylem Inc. (XYL) provides pumps and aeration systems specifically to aquaculture companies to improve water usage efficiency.

So far, aquaculture companies have saved 30% on energy costs due to the pumps.

Xylem Inc. (XYL)

5 Year Price →

119.84
(+100.10%)



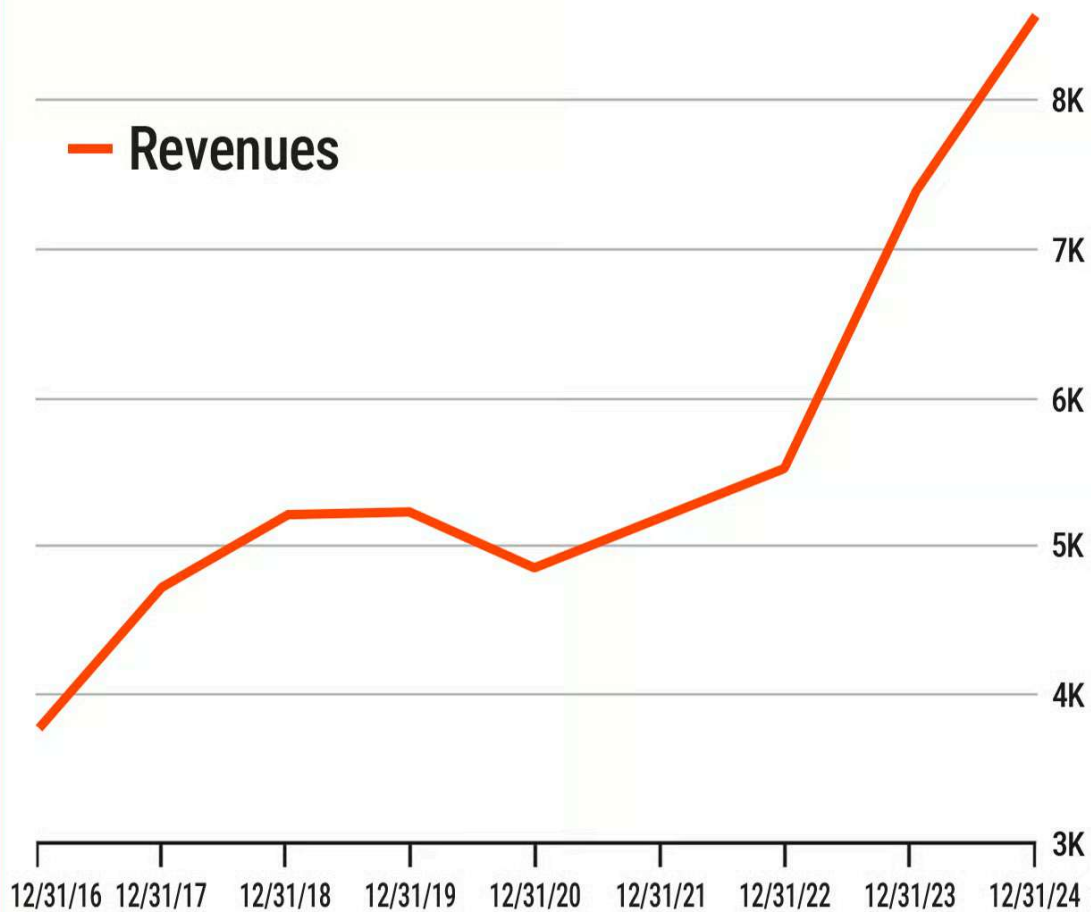
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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

What makes them so efficient? Xylem has created sensors that know the exact moment when to pump water out to be filtered.

Its pumps also add oxygen to the water through aeration, which means fish receive more oxygen than they would in the ocean, helping them to live 20% longer in captivity than in the wild.

Xylem Inc. (XYL)



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Data [via](#) company reports

Last year, Xylem generated \$8.5 billion in revenue - a year-over-year jump from \$7.3 billion in 2023.

The bottom line: Improving efficiency with specialized equipment helps aquaculture companies reduce costs and save money, which has led to safer water conditions and healthier fish.

iShares Emergent Food And AgTech Multisector ETF (IVEG)

21.01
(-12.28%)

3 Year Price →



 Market Briefs Pro

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

Other broader opportunities exist in this niche as well - with the iShares Emergent Food and AgTech Multisector ETF (IVEG) giving investors exposure to several aquaculture companies at once and a dividend yield of 1.83%.

PRODUCTION

From Farms, To Your Front Door

Once fish are grown, aquaculture works with special processing companies to deliver them to tables all around the world.

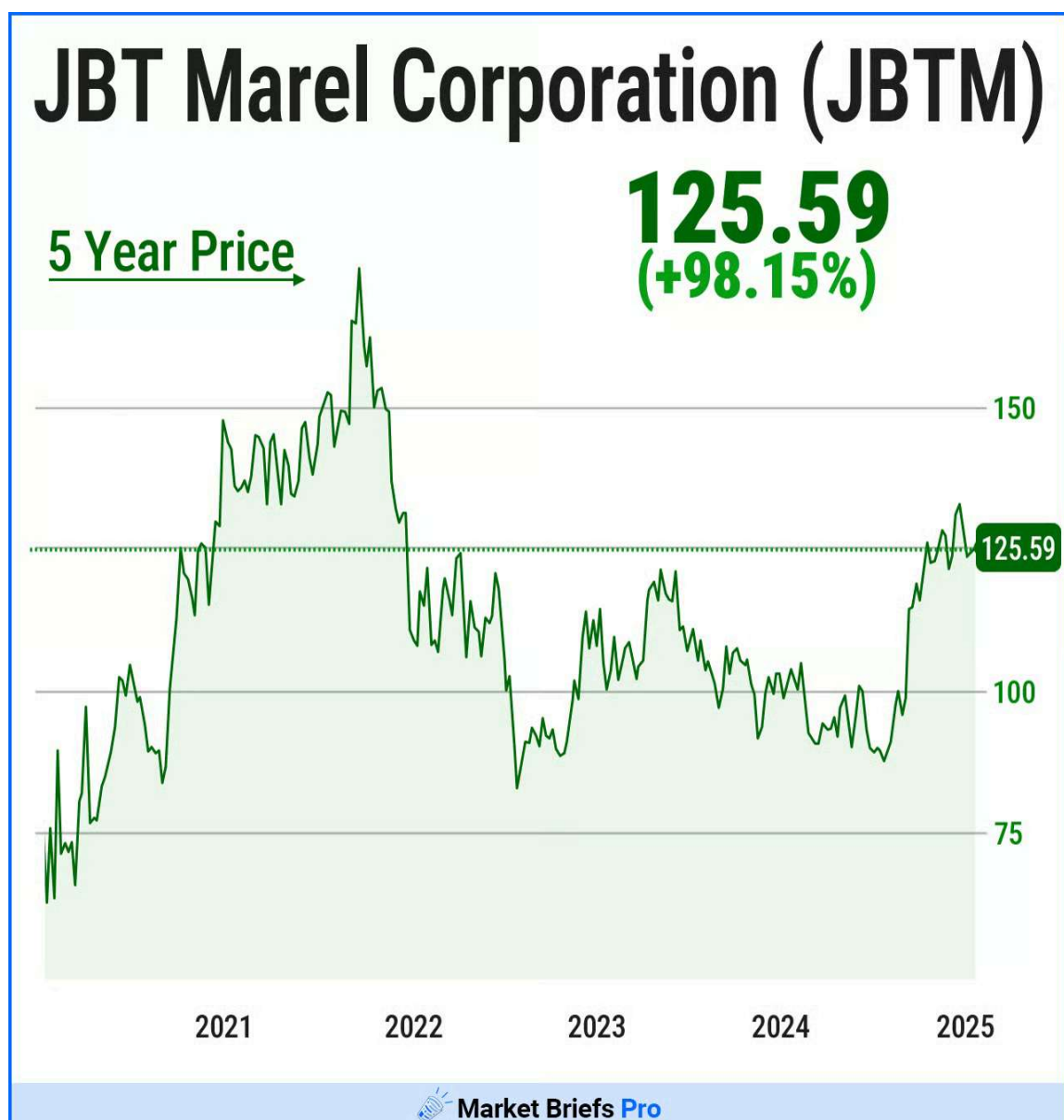
This involves harvesting the fish humanely, using custom tools that preserve freshness and reduce waste.

As of 2024, roughly 15% of the world's seafood from oceans and fish farms is labeled unusable and discarded.

Why? Improper handling during and after a fish is harvested makes it inedible.

To solve this problem, aquaculture companies have tasked food manufacturing companies like JBT Marel Corp (JBTM) with making sure every fish can be processed and sold sustainably.

"Sustainability is a significant challenge in aquaculture today, with a complex mix of environmental, and social factors impacting the industry. 83% of consumers are motivated to some degree to choose seafood with a sustainability label." - Aquaculture Stewardship Council.

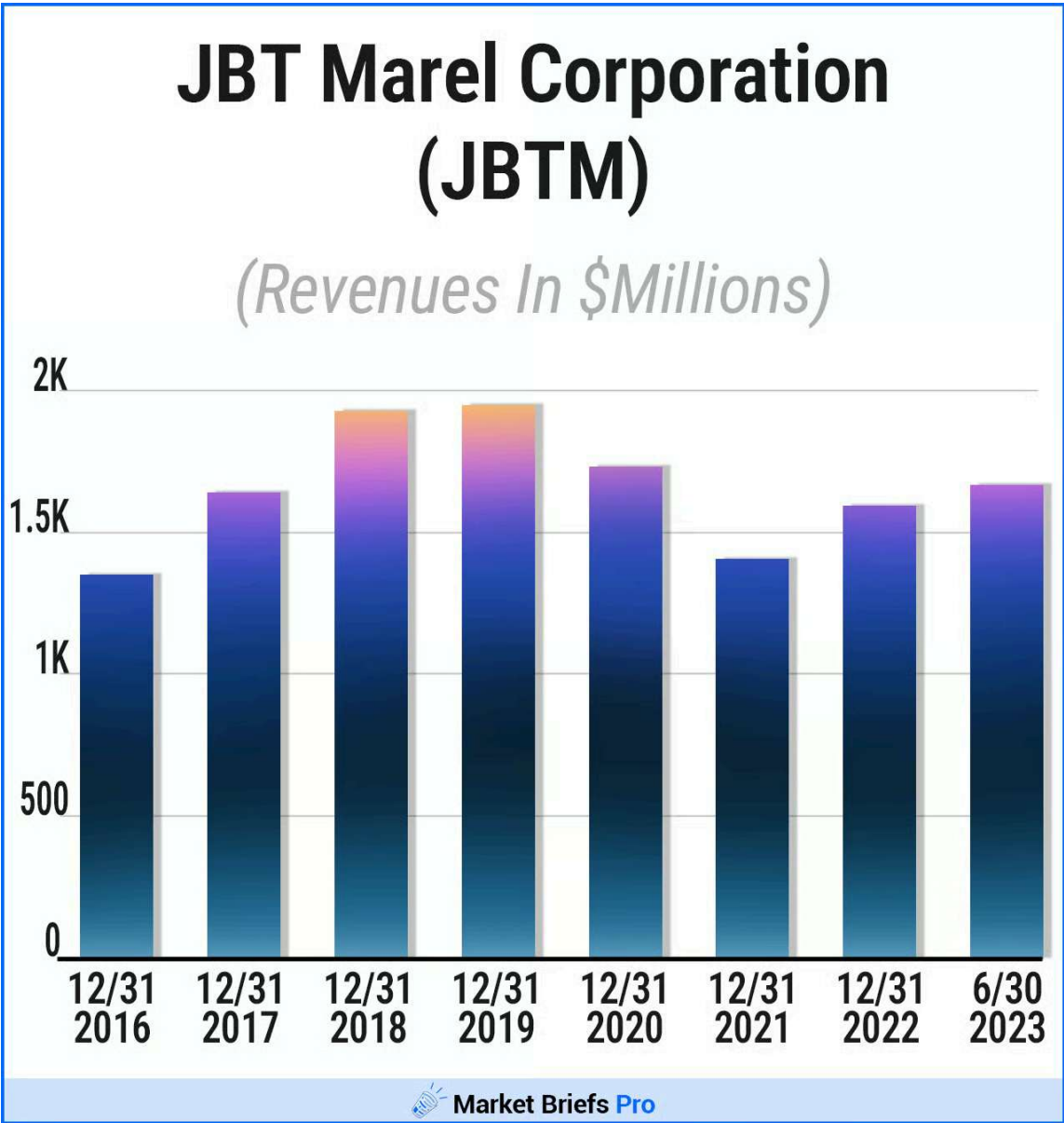


Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

JBT Marel Corp has designed state-of-the-art deboning tech that increases the amount of food procured from each fish.

In other words, its tech increases the amount of fish aquaculture companies can sell by 5% by removing up to 100% of a fish's bones during harvesting.

Its systems are also faster than the competition, too - JBT Marel Corp's tech operates 30% faster, so more fish can be processed.



Data via company reports

- That has meant aquaculture facilities can process 25% more fish per hour, which has helped them meet demand.

JBT Marel has seen its revenue fall slightly since it hit a record high of \$1.9 billion in 2019, which was mostly related to flu outbreaks that affected its traditional avian farm sectors.

However, after its revenue fell from 2020 - 2021, it has since increased every year, reaching \$1.6 billion in 2024 mainly due to its aquaculture segment growth.

After fish is harvested, businesses then ship it to restaurants and grocery stores where it can be sold.

US Foods (USFD) is one of the biggest companies specializing in the production of seafood today.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

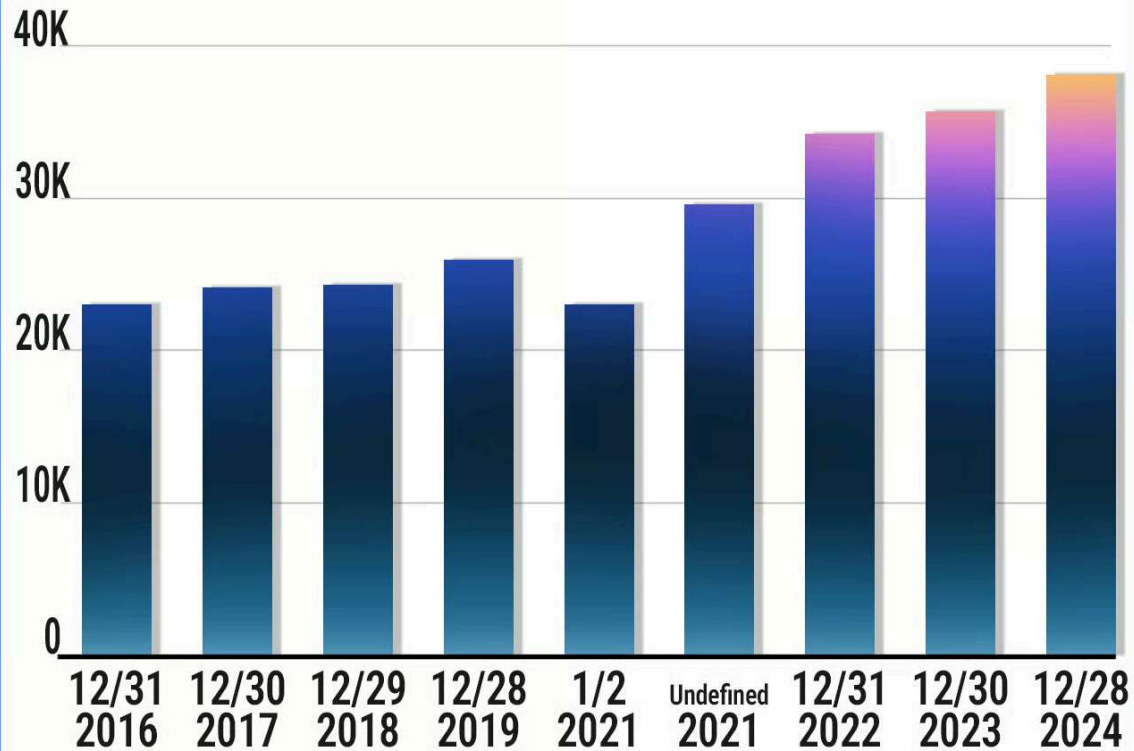
US Foods sells its seafood primarily to restaurants, where more than half of all seafood is consumed.

It's also actively investing in farm-raised seafood brands - acquiring Renzi Foodservice and Saladino's Foodservice in 2023.

- It's now the largest wholesaler of seafood in the U.S., generating 27% of the wholesaler seafood market's revenue.

US Foods Holding Corporation (USFD)

(Revenues In \$Millions)



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Data via company reports

After seeing its revenue fall in 2020, mainly due to the pandemic, it has managed to bounce back and increase its revenue every year since.

- US Foods reported a record-high revenue of almost \$40 billion in 2024, up from \$30 billion in 2021.

Aquaculture will need more processing and production capabilities as demand grows - which means an increase in investing opportunities.

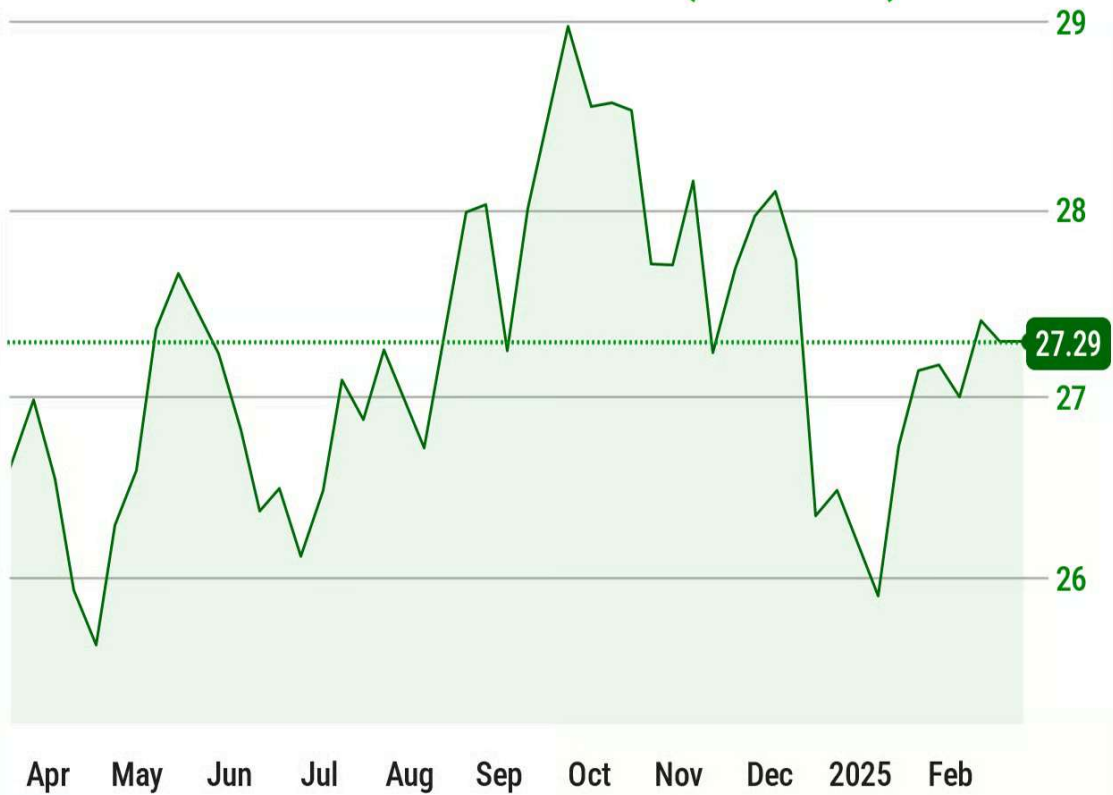
Investors can also turn to the KraneShares Rockefeller Ocean Engagement ETF (KSEA) for broad market exposure to this shift in fish farming processing and production.

- KSEA has a dividend yield of 0.84%.

Kraneshares Rockefeller Ocean Engagement ETF (KSEA)

1 Year Price →

27.29
(+1.86%)



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Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

RISKS

Smelling Fishy...

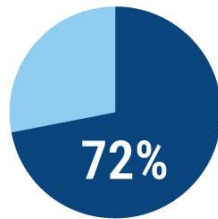
Despite many growing opportunities in aquaculture, investors will still need to watch out for some risks that could be a bit *fishy*:

First, while demand for fish is growing, other meats like beef and chicken still hold more market share.

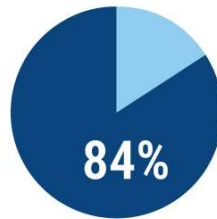
- This means that consumers still like eating beef and chicken more, at least for now.

Weekly Protein Consumption Trends In 2024: Consumer Preferences By Protein Type

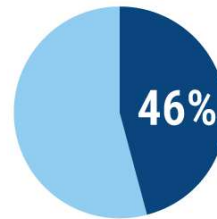
Percent (%) Of Consumers Eating Each Protein Weekly



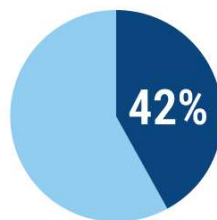
Beef



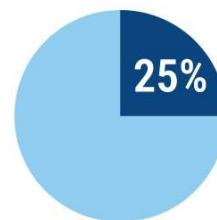
Chicken



Pork



Fish



Meat Alternatives

Chicken And Beef Are The Proteins Most Likely To Be Consumed At Least Weekly.

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Data [via](#) Consumer Beef Tracker

Speaking of taste buds - no one knows how consumers will feel about fish in the coming years.

There's no guarantee that fish consumption will grow and that fish populations in the oceans will continue to decrease.

Lastly, live animals always run the risk of developing a disease or spreading germs that could lead to loss of fish stock.

- In 2022, the number of fish infected with salmonella increased, which led to several Americans hospitalized.

When disease outbreaks happen, that not only impacts the number of fish that can be sold, but also a brand's reputation.

Ultimately, Americans may choose to avoid fish during outbreaks, meaning fewer sales and less revenue for aquaculture facilities and the companies they work with.

Poorly managed aquaculture practices can also have a large impact on the fish we eat, according to experts at the Aquaculture Stewardship Council:

"If aquaculture is not well managed, it can have a range of adverse impacts, including water pollution, disruption of local ecosystems and poor working conditions. The faster the aquaculture industry grows, the greater its potential impact on the environment and local communities."

REVIEW

Are There Plenty Of Fish In The Sea?

If you've eaten fish in the last five years, chances are it was from a fish farm.

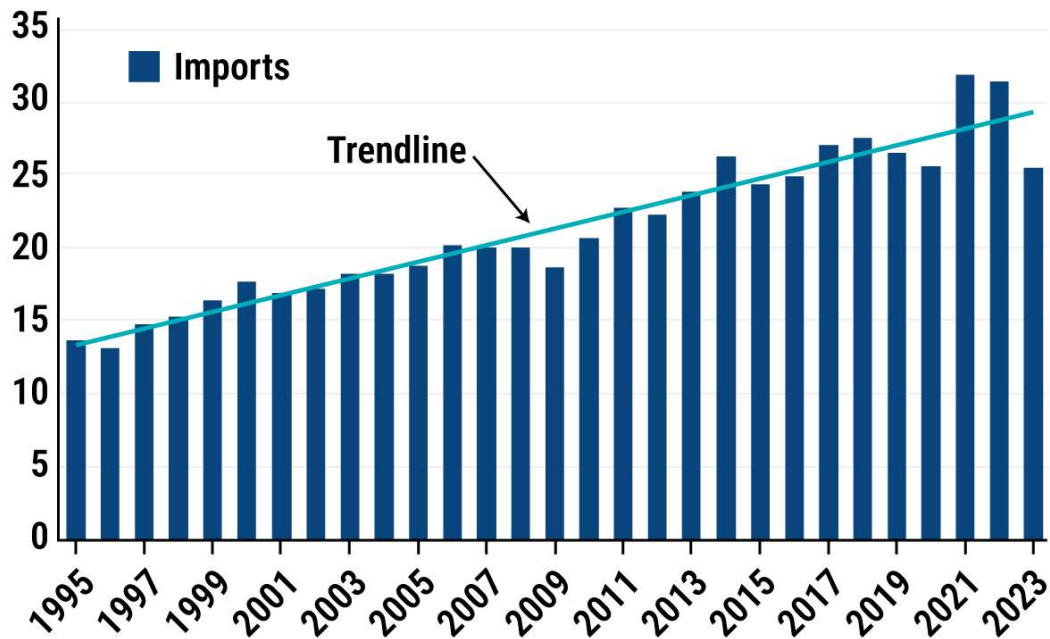
That's because there just aren't enough fish in the ocean anymore to support rising fish demand across the globe.

And while there's a small chance that could change, it's more likely that aquaculture will continue to grow in order to support fish demand in the U.S.

"The U.S. stands amongst the Top 10 world producers in terms of capture fisheries - as with many other countries, the U.S. is heavily reliant on seafood and aquaculture products and it is undeniable that aquaculture will be a key part of the solution in the years ahead." - Bertrand Charron, ASC Global Director of Research & Insights.

Rising U.S. Seafood Imports: Three Decades Of Growth

2023 U.S. Dollars (Billions)



Note: The Import Seafood Values Are Adjusted For Inflation Based On 2023 Dollar Values Using The Consumer Price Index For All Items Consumed By Urban Consumers, As Published By The U.S. Department Of Labor, Bureau Of Labor Statistics.

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Data via USDA

This means that fish farms will need more services like nutrition, equipment, and processing - that has created a long-term opportunity for businesses within those aquaculture niches.

As of 2025, the aquaculture market is estimated to be worth around \$250 billion but that could grow to over \$370 billion by 2034, according to Precedence Research.

As it grows, so will the innovations that involve aquaculture, along with the many opportunities for investors to profit.



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